



Research evidence to policy

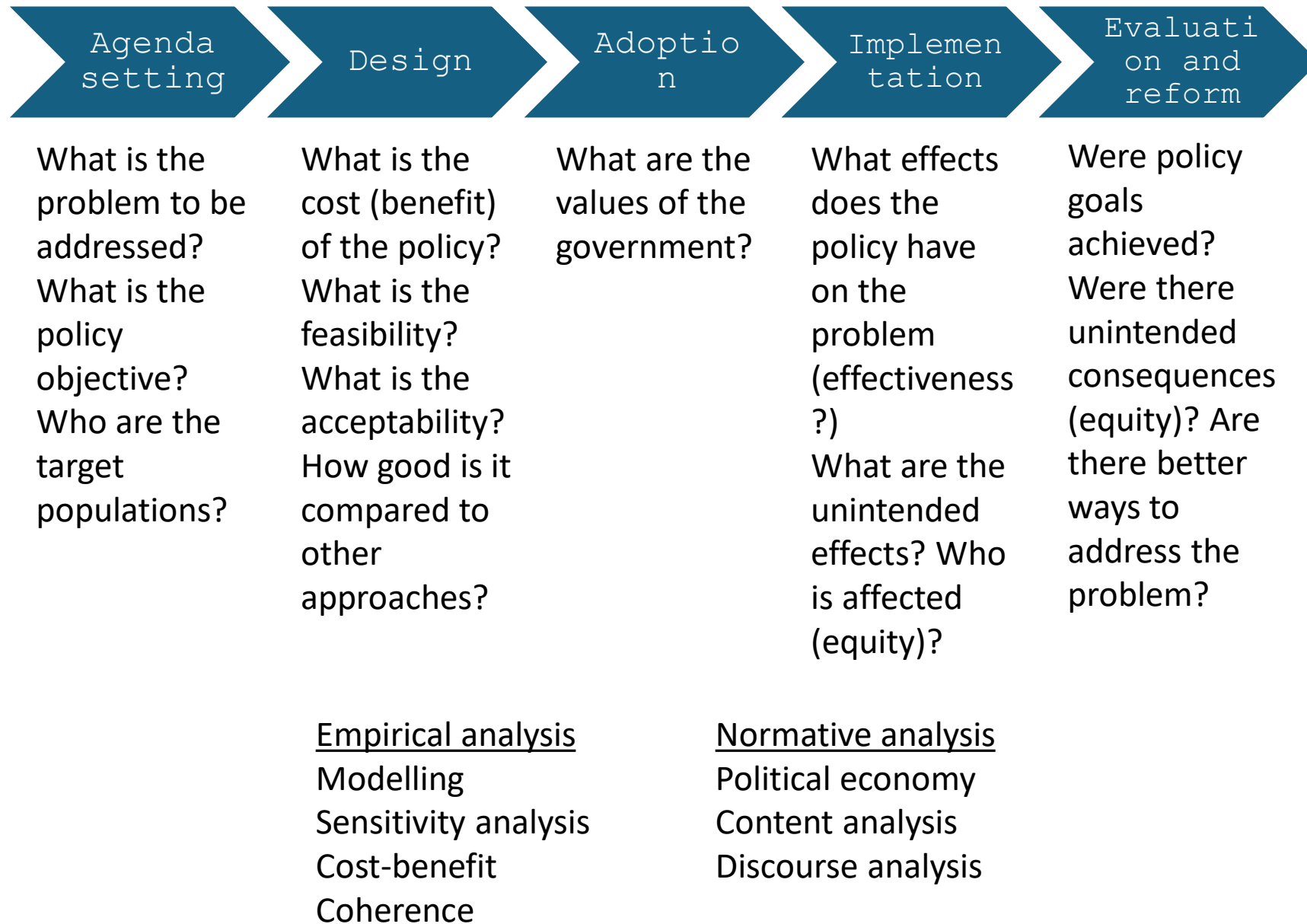
Module 4



Research interest's discussion

What are you
researching
on?

What is the
one key
significant
finding from
your work?



Dissemination to policy makers

- There are both formal and informal routes to reach various policy makers
- But first, who are these policy makers? Broader word is policy actors
- Traditionally- government- officers, parliament, MCA's etc. Decision makers
- Non-traditional - NGO/INGO leaders, key community actors- gatekeepers



Dissemination methods



Policy briefs



Impact briefs – more general



Case studies



Blogs/social media LinkedIn,
Twitter,



Press releases/statements



Dissemination
workshops –

BRECCIA
GECRESS

8 Ways to influence policy makers

- High quality research
- Relevant and readable research
- Understand processes, context and key actors (policy windows) – Wajir governor
- Be accessible – engage from the beginning
- Decide if you want to be an advocate or broker
- Build relationships
- Network – e.g with media or other entrepreneurial sources
- Reflect continuously

Messaging assignment

- **Class group Assignment** – In groups of 2, write one paragraph explaining the key message in your research – the evidence that backs it up, and why this would be of interest to policy makers in government – your target audience.

Writing a policy brief

- Let us critique an example of a published policy brief.
- – APHRC and Kajiado policy brief in the materials.

Writing a policy brief

- **Do's**

- Emotive picture relevant to the topic
- Use of percentages which are easy statistics
- Have references, similar to academic contacts
- Has all relevant email contacts.
- Link findings directly to recommendations
- Don't have a lot of written work. 2-3 key findings with 2-3 recommendations
- Practical and actionable recommendations.

Take home assignment (Individual)

- Write a policy brief relevant to your research using the template provided in the materials

Resource links

- KIPPRA – Kenya institute of public policy research
 - <https://kippra.or.ke/>
- Busara centre for behavioral research– good examples of case studies, research newsletters, blogs and policy briefs
 - <https://busara.global/>
- **Reading:** Chapter 11, Public policy and research in Africa book. Chapter title: From research to policy action, communicating research for public policy making.